Session 22

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban, Mehdipatnam
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	K Sainath
Gender	Male
Age	28
Education	Class 12
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 2 They live in a join family although (total 8 members in joint family)
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Photocopy and PAN/TIN online services (NSDL & ME Seva)
Bank account ownership	Account with SBI & Vijaya Bank – personal, Loan account with united bank
Type of mobile phone	Smartphone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 120,000-160,000
Category of respondent	3

Business establishment

Mr. K Sainath has two running shops in his name. The first shop is 7 years old and the second shop is 4 years old. Sainath started his business with the photocopy and cybercafé services, 7 years ago at the age of 21. He continued this business for some years but after seeing decline in footfall for cyber café needs, Mr. Sainath diversified his business and became an authorized service provider of online services under Mee Seva (Integrated Service Delivery Gateway of Telangana). This has diversified his source of income. Later on, Mr. Sainath also opened another shop (the second shop). The second shop is also into photocopy services and provide online TIN Facilitation services authorized by NSDL. This shop is near college so have high demand of photocopy as well as other form filling requirements. Both the shops together accounts monthly sales of Rs. 120,000 to 160,000.

Managing business activities

It took Mr. Sainath, INR 250,000 initial investment in setting up his second shop. He manages both the shops and there are 4 staff members in his two shops. All the staff members are trained by Mr. Sainath. Mr. Sainath has high money requirements in the initial 12 days of each month (i.e. from 1st to 12th of each month) on account of bill over dues and loan EMI. However, he takes out the money in the second half of the month for his other than business commitments.

The major proportion of income comes from photocopy business (approximately 60-70%) and the rest comes from the government authorized online services (approximately 30-40%). His shop is registered and have proper license.

In terms of income, the older shop is able to do a business of INR 90k-1.1 L per month whereas, the newer shop is able to do INR 50-55K.

Expenses includes rent, paper & other material and Light bill as major overheads. Since both the shops are on rent, INR 13-15K each shop goes into rent. Other material cost used to be around 12-20K per month which varies in the above range.

In terms of book keeping, Mr. Sainath does not maintain any books of account. He says, ***"Bharose ka aadmi log rehta to mai hisaab wagairah ke deep me nahi jaata. Saara staff idhar apne bhai jaisa hota iske liye account maintain karne ka zaroorat hi nahi"***

In terms of aspirations regarding the shop, he wants to add more good quality photocopy machines which can increase his margins. Right now, there is 50% margin on the photocopy. He does not have any other very big aspiration in life as such.

He has also told that in case of sudden profit, he will put that extra money into business only

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

The major challenge in the business for Mr. Sainath is the increasing rent. He said that the rent increases every year whereas the prices of our services are almost same since last 2-3 years. Among others, on the operational side, there is an issue of server (down) and wiring. And on the personnel front, having and retaining the skilled and trustworthy employees at such a low pay scale is another major challenge in his business (for future per se).

In the words of Mr. Sainath, the operational issue of server and wiring are hard to avoid. However, to tackle the rental expenses, we can think of buying an own space. On the personnel front, the staff which I have trained are till now with me and can be trusted as I treat them as my brothers.

Mr. Sainath also said that competition from other entrepreneurs cannot be considered as a big challenge despite the fact that it is high in our line of business. Customers become a loyal customer due to the good behavior and patience level of the entrepreneurs in this type of business. Mr. Sainath has a good chunk of repeat customers and he is ready to beat any competition by reducing his margins and improving his services.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Mr. Sainath has two bank accounts with Vijaya bank and SBI. However, he put all his monthly earnings in his current account just to meet the business expenses and keep the extra cash. He is not able to earn any interest on his monthly saving since he just put his money in the interest less current account. He is also reluctant in depositing money in the savings account due to charges on cash deposit. Since all his money is in cash, he thinks that he has to pay additional charges for such high cash deposit in his savings account.

Other than depositing his money into savings account, Mr Sainath also invest in **chit funds** and draws out money from it in case of any need. Putting money into chit funds is very common in Hyderabad and this has also prompted Mr. Sainath.

Mr. Sainath also has a health insurance policy from Star Health.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Mr. Sainath owns a smart phone and very well aware about the digital payment systems and online payment apps- BHIM, Paytm, Aadhaar, Google Pay etc. He uses 'ultra-cash' and 'google pay' frequently however, he only accepts cash in most of the cases and major dealings are cash based only. As per Mr. Sainath, there are some trust issues as well with the apps like Paytm and that is the reason many customers as well as he himself, don't believe much on the digital payment interface. In case a transaction fails, it takes a lot of time in returning money. For him cash is the fastest and most secured way of transacting the money in business.

Past learning experience and training support required

Mr. Sainath thinks that there is no need of training for him or his staff. The business nuances are for self-learning. All his staff has good understanding of basic of technical know-how for the business. The additional things are easily teachable. There are online training modules by NSDL for PAN and TIN services. Which is sufficient for the business.

As per Mr. Sainath, everyone understands computer very well and can operate on photocopy machine easily. Still in case of any doubt, we reach out to customer care and most of our problems were solved timely.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Mr. Sainath has taken a loan of INR 200,000 and after expenses, he is able to earn 60,000-90,000 per month. The photocopy machine cost is approximately INR 70 Thousand.
He is not willing to share any further personal or business data. Favorite

Session 23

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban, Mehdipatnam
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Satish SIngh
Gender	Male
Age	40
Education	Class 10
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 4 They live in a join family although
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Retailer of plastic/paper groceries (glasses, Pattals, Brushes etc.)
Bank account ownership	Account with SBI; Loan from United Bank of India

Type of mobile phone	Feature Phone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 60,000 – 90,000
Category of respondent	2

Business establishment

Mr. Satish is working in the shop since he was 12 years old. Earlier when he was 12 years old, he used to support his father and later taken it over at the age of almost 25 years. He got this shop from his father. He has two brothers and there are 2 shops in the family. The other two brothers sit in the different shop. Mr. Singh has learned the business from his father only. He does not need to bother much about the establishment of the business as the shop is more than 32 years old. The infrastructure of the shop is also quite old and Mr. Singh is running the shop as he inherited from his father. Nothing much has been done.

Managing business activities

Mr. Singh has an experience of 28 years in this business. He is managing daily business activities in the same manner since last 20 years. The daily shop earnings varies from INR 2K to 4K. The margin is very low though and ranges only from 15-20% on all the products. The transactions are in cash completely and there is no use of payment wallets or digital interface for payments. In his word, “Hum loga ko roz ka roz paiso ki zaroorat rehta, isliye sab hath ke haath hi chalta hai. Saamaan lo aur cash do”. Also, he said that there is no demand of online payments in the market. The purchase amount is so low that it will not be feasible for customer and us.

The major expenses other than the purchase of material includes light bill (which is on average INR 300-400). Since the shop is owned so no rental expenses are there. The shop is registered & licensed with GHMC. The annual renewal charges of license are INR 300 only.

After taking into account all the income and expenses, the monthly saving of Mr. Singh varies from INR 5K to INR 10K. Despite of this much of savings, he does not deposit this amount in the bank but keeps it with him at hand and mostly invest in the business again. In case of higher savings than normal, he will still invest into his business in buying more and more, variety products. However, in case of further savings and with the support from financing company, he is willing to own a Godown someday to keep the material in stock.

On maintain the books of account, Mr. Singh responded ***"Sir sab Muh Zabaani Yaad rakhte hain. 28 saal se business kar rahe hain, kabhi zaroorat nahi padi"***. However, he was not able to answer when we asked him about his earnings of January 2019. He later agrees to the need of maintaining proper books of account.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

There are no major challenges as per Mr. Singh in his area of work. Though he thinks that when his 4 kids will grow further, he might be in a requirement of high amount of money for their education and all. He is aware that in present scenario, his savings will not support their future. His only challenge is to increase his earnings, which seems to be difficult under the current setup.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Mr. Singh has a savings account with SBI. He has also taken a loan 4 months back of INR 200,000 through Sub-K from UBI. Despite of having a SBI savings account, Mr. Singh don't deposit much there. His awareness of banking products and usage is at minimal. On knowing about the loan product features, his words were- Hum ek hi cheez seekhe hain saahab- wo hai time to time payment karna". However, he was not aware that what what would happen if he misses the instalment. He said- ***"Penalty wagairah lagti hogi saab, idea nahi"***.

Mr. Singh was also not aware about credit score which is important in getting loan from financial institutions. And despite of having a savings account with SBI, he never approached SBI for the loan. He took the loan from Sub-K based on a reference and when Sub-K executive reached out to him to understand his requirements.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Mr. Singh uses a feature phone and unaware of operating a smart phone. Though, he plans to buy a smart phone someday and said that he will learn to operate from his brother. Digital infrastructure was very limited as far as Mr. Singh's life is concerned. Since he doesn't use a smart phone, he was not much aware about the social media apps, payment apps etc. 100% transactions are cash based.

Past learning experience and training support required

Mr. Singh believes that experience is the most critical aspect in business and he can handle any situation without training on business. However, he feels that a training on managing books of account may be helpful in future and he can work in amore planned way after that.

On the mode of training, Mr. Singh was OK for the online as well as Classroom training. Though he prefers a classroom training if it is for 1-2 hours at a nearby place.

Willingness to share personal and business data

He is not willing to share any further personal or business data.

Session 24

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban, Mehdipatnam
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Prakash
Gender	Male
Age	44
Education	Class 12
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 2
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Ladies Tailor
Bank account ownership	Closed account with SBI, now only have credit account with United Bank of India
Type of mobile phone	Smart Phone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 70,000-90,000
Category of respondent	2

Business establishment

Mr. Prakash is into the business of tailoring since last 29 years. He learned this from one of his relative as he used to work with him. Later he opened a shop, which was on rent in 1990. He made his reputation in the market from that shop, improved his skills, earned some loyal customers. Since the rent was very high for him, Mr. Prakash decided to own a shop as he was not able to save much and his most of the earnings were going into the rent. Hence, 4 years back he bought a shop at INR 15,00,000 with the help of his savings/relatives and money from chit fund scheme. At present, he is running his business in the new location from his new shop and there are 4 female employees work under him on per piece basis/no fixed salary. Mr. Prakash is very well versed in his work and he had also given coaching to many people on tailoring work for 1 year in the past.

Managing business activities

Mr. Prakash has total experience of about 29 years and he is managing all day to day business activities by himself. He goes himself to the nearby market in the Hyderabad to buy all the needed material just to make sure the best quality product at the best possible price. The total sales per month varies from 70K-90K and it depends a lot on the seasonality. The best seasons are during Ramzan and Marriage season (oct-Jan).

Average monthly expenses include light bill, salaries and other operation parameters. This amounted to INR 25K-30K. Hence, after detecting all the monthly expenses from the sales, Mr. Prakash is able to earn INR 40-60K per month.

50% customers among all are usually the repeat customers for Mr. Prakash. **In order to save the time, he keeps a track of the measurement of some of his very regular customers in a separate notebook.** He also uses social media platform such as Whatsapp in sharing the designs of clothes with his customers. He says, *"Main whatsapp pe madam logo ko design bhejta hu. Kuch madam ko agar design pasand aata hai toh wo driver ke through kapda bhej deti hain aur main bana ke de deta hu. Unka naap sab apne paas pehle se rehta hai."*

Mr. Prakash, also maintains a separate book of account. He keeps a track of all the orders in his own way. Formatting of the account book is though not proper. Mr. Prakash thinks that his method is perfect in maintaining the books of account and it is more convenient for him. He is not very much in the favor of a training module due to crunch of time.

In future Mr. Prakash wants to expand and covert his business into a full-fledged textile shop in which he will keep the stock of designer clothes and will also tailoring services.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

Mr. Prakash was facing difficulty in savings earlier when he did not have his own shop. He had to pay a lot of money in rent. However, to tackle this problem, he planned bought a shop at INR 1500,000. To arrange this big amount of INR 1500,000, he took out the money from his chit fund savings (700,000) and also borrowed INR 2L from relatives. The rest of the money was managed by his savings over the years. Since, now he has his own shop, he doesn't think that there is any other problem that he is currently facing. He is fine with all other things.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Mr. Prakash at present only have a credit account with United Bank of India, He closed his savings account with SBI as his branch was very far from his residence or place of work. He doesn't believe in saving with the bank. Most of the money earned by him is being used in the business and household expenses. He also puts INR 30,000 every month in Chitti (chit funds).

Mr. Prakash is also unaware about the different financial welfare schemes launched by the Government of India. Usage level of banking products is very low.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

The 100% transaction at the shop is in cash only. Mr. Prakash has QR code of Paytm for his shop and also it was displayed at counter, however he does not accept it due to fear of it not being safe. He has heard from 2-3 of his friends about the frauds through the Paytm wallet.

Mr. Prakash owns a smart phone and uses social media apps like whatsapp and facebook extensively. He also shares the designs of clothes on whatsapp with his regular customer. In case a customer is busy, he sends the pics of design to the customer on whatsapp and they select it. In his words, *"Mai madam log ko whatsapp pe design bhej deta hu, Madam log design pasand karke driver se kapda bhijwa dete hain. Mai complete karke deliver kar deta hu."*

Past learning experience and training support required

Mr. Prakash claimed that he is well trained in his business. He is a self-trained and self-made person who had also trained many people for one year as he used to give coaching classes as well on tailoring. He said, *"Ek baar design dikha dijiye mai ready karke de dunga"*.

He doesn't feel any other kind of help on book keeping or banking products. However, as a general feedback, he prefers any training module to be in the form of video as many business persons don't have time to attend a workshop. He also thinks that the video should not be lengthy and must have real people acting in it in place of cartoons.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Mr. Praksah was ready to share business related information which is not very confidential in nature, but not the personal information like Aadhaar/Pan Card etc.

Session 25

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban, Mehdipatnam
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Syed Sabir
Gender	Male
Age	49
Education	Class 12
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 2
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Hardware/Sanitary/Glass Shop
Bank account ownership	Synidcate Bank- Savings and Current Account; United Bank- Credit
Type of mobile phone	Smart Phone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 240,000-300,000
Category of respondent	4

Business establishment

Mr. Syed, the only bread earner in the family of 4 had started the business of hardware, sanitary items of household need almost 18 years ago. He initially started with the footwear shop followed by crockery shop but then settled with the hardware & other household items. He has learnt the nuances of this business from his brother. He is there in this business for a long time and his shop is at the same place from 18 years, though it is on rent.

Managing business activities

Mr. Syed has 4 staff members to support him. All the business dealings are done by him he doesn't have much trust on his staff. Mr. Syed sells material worth INR 8000-10000 in a day. He provides fitting services in case of purchase of glass.

Major monthly Income vs expenses include rent of INR 30,000 and Light Bill of INR 3000-5000. Monthly salary of INR 10,000 to 2 staff and INR 6000 to other 2 (helper). One time annual charges include:

- Property Tax: INR 1500
- Labor Tax: INR 2000
- Municipal Body Charges: INR 2000

Mr. Syed also pays GST as his shop is GST registered. He takes the help of a chartered accountant in paying GST.

The margin that Mr. Syed gets is as low as 10%. On the items that he purchases, he gets a credit of 30 days from his supplier. He also gives items on credit to some of the selected buyers in case of bulk orders. Most of the business runs on cash.

Mr. Syed does not maintain any books of account. He never felt a need of maintain such an account book as he is the only person making & authorizing all the transactions and dealing with suppliers and customers directly. The staff members are just there to support in carrying the material, home delivery of material and for fitting services of glass at customer's home. ***"Na Bechne ka hisaab rakhte hain, na kharidne ka..Sab dimaag mein rehta hai sir. 18 saal se yahi to kar rahe hain"***.

Recently Mr. Syed has expanded his shop, for which he also took a loan of INR 200,000 from United Bank of India through Sub-K. In case of any extra profit. Mr. Syed will utilize that in his business only. Also he does not believe in competition and says that if the shop is old and offers material at reasonable rates, then it will have good sales.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

The main challenges explained by Mr. Syed includes:

- **The Manpower challenge/Laborer Issues**: The hired staff leaves the job without intimation. Workers also take leave without even informing the owner. *"Kaam Walo ki Koi Guarantee Nahi hai, sab apni marzi se chalte hain"*
- **The Fragile Items**: The glass items are very fragile and in case of not handled properly, can cause huge loss. Mr. Syed had to face the problems earlier when while delivering the glasses, it broke due to mishandling.

These challenges are existing for Mr. Syed and he does not have any clue to solve them.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Mr. Syed has savings and current account with Syndicate bank. He had taken a loan of INR 300,000 earlier from Syndicate Bank as well. Currently he has a running loan of INR 200,000 from United Bank. He doesn't have any insurance or other banking/financial product.

Mr. Syed has also enrolled in a chit fund scheme of 200,000 and pays some INR 10,000 every month for this. He is not aware of any government support for micro and small entrepreneurs through any scheme.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

It's a cash and carry business for Mr. Syed. In some cases, he gives cheques also to his suppliers. All the payments are taken in cash.Mr. Syed was aware about the digital payment platforms like Paytm but he is not using them. He also does not have any PoS machine as he said that *"log 5-10 Rs ke liye bhi card dene lagte hain agar machine rehti hai toh"*. Mr. syed also does not use net banking.

On the other side, he uses whatsapp regularly for chatting purpose and also placing order to his suppliers in some cases. He sends photos and videos through it as well.

Past learning experience and training support required

Mr. Syed never attended any skill building exercise earlier in his life. However, he believes that a training can be helpful on any of the business related aspect but he wants a classroom based training program in the Hindi language in Hyderabad. He feels that videos will not have that much impact. Also, he will be able to socialise if there is a classroom training with other entrepreneurs.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Mr. Syed was not ready to share his personal/business details for public usage.

Day 2 (11th June, 2019)

Session 26

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban, Rehmath Nagar
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	N Sachin Narayan
Gender	Male
Age	51
Education	Class 10
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 2
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Tailor
Bank account ownership	Account with SBI & Andhra Bank – personal, Loan account with united bank
Type of mobile phone	Smartphone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 80,000-100,000
Category of respondent	2

Business establishment

Mr. Narayan is running the business of tailoring services from last 25 years. He has a very small shop which is on rent. This tailoring business was his preferred choice when he decided to enter into the field of business, 25 years ago. As he had learnt all the nuances of tailoring from his father (who was also a tailor), hence it was in a way an easy choice for Mr. Narayan. Mr. Narayan is still running his business from the same shop, which he had taken on rent 25 years ago, despite of the fact that it is extremely small in size. As per Mr. Narayan, the reason for not changing or expanding the shop lies in 'Vaastu shaastra' (Hindu belief system in architecture). Mr. Narayan thinks that this shop is luck for him as it is east facing. Even though he has the capability to expand the shop, he will not as he doesn't want to make any changes in the current architecture of the shop.

Managing business activities

Mr. Narayan started his business with a very small investment with help of his father and with very basic sewing machine. At present, he has a good number of repeat customers and a modern machine to work. He has recently bought a second hand sewing machine which costed him INR 35,000. There are two workers from last ten years in his shop, and Mr. Narayan trust them a lot.

Mr. Narayan has a small setup of sewing machine at his home as well and in case of bulk order, he works till late as well to complete the order on time.

On a daily basis, Mr. Narayan receives at least 4-5 couplet of clothes and on each couplet he earns around INR 680. At present, Mr. Narayan's margin ranges between 45-50%. He also delivers the completed items at home of customers in few cases.

Major expenses include the salary of staff, rent and the electricity bill.

In terms of book keeping, Mr. Narayan maintains a bill book and the format of the same can be easily comprehended. However, all the note making is pen-paper based and no digital medium is used form the same. Mr. Narayan is also not keeping a track of his expenses as he just notes the items that he sells/delivers.

As per Mr. Narayan, in case of extra profit, he will put that extra money into his savings bank account as his normal daily earnings are comfortably covering his business needs already. He is not having very high aspirations as his both the sons are capable of earning for themselves. One of the son is also working in an MNC at a decent package.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

There are no major risks or challenges in the business as per Mr. Narayan. Only major challenge that he could think of was arranging money for a small entrepreneur like him to buy expensive machines.
As per his earlier experience, he could not buy an advance machine once because he was denied the loan. On any other possible challenge Mr. Narayan says, ***"Ek baar business me puraane ho gaye toh saare challenge handle ho jaate hain. Experience sab sikha deta hai. Tailoring me toh bus customer khush hona chaihye, aur koi challenge nahi hai."***

Mr. Narayan does not think that online or even local competition is a challenge for him considering his vintage.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Mr. Narayan has two savings account and a credit account. He had also taken a car loan and loan for his newly bough phone. He is aware about banking products and processes (thanks to his elder son who explained him a lot- as he had also worked in ICICI Bank). Currently Mr. Narayan has a INR 100,000 Loan on his business.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Mr. Narayan is also very well aware of digital payment systems. He accepts almost all payment modes through Google pay, Paytm, PhonePe, UPI etc. However, he personally prefers cash as most of his purchases are in cash only.

Past learning experience and training support required

Mr. Narayan gives priority to experience and self-learning over training. He for himself does not feel any requirement of training on any topic related to his business. He also feels that the training will need time and he does not have time. However, he said that videos on mobile phones if interesting on topic can be watched in free time after lunch or before going to sleep. His preferred language is Hindi and time duration is 10 mins max.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Mr. Narayan is not comfortable in sharing any personal information or business information except his phone number.

Session 27

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban, Rehmath Nagar
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Sheikh Ahmad
Gender	Male
Age	38
Education	Class 7
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 4
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Matching Centre (Retailer)
Bank account ownership	Account with HDFC; Savings Account with SBI
Type of mobile phone	Smart Phone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 180,000-210,000
Category of respondent	3

Business establishment

Mr. Ahmad started the business with button hole activity. He purchased two machines for the same. To start this business, he had borrowed a loan of INR 50,000 from his brother. The initial time was tough in the business as per Mr. Ahmad. He started business with zero experience and was completely unknown of the facts of running a business, but he survived that crucial starting time with the help of his family. After 8-10 months of opening of shop, he managed to attain the stability in the business and his earnings improved.

Managing business activities

Mr. Ahmad is managing his business with the help of 2 other staff members. The shop is old and have good customer turnaround. Almost 90% of the customers are repeat customers. The daily earnings are in the range of INR 6K to 8K with a margin of 10-12% on each product. The major expenses of Mr. Ahmad is the salary of staff (INR 10,000 per month) and Light Bill (INR 1000 per month).

Mr. Ahmad himself goes to the market to purchase the material and all the material is purchased from the local nearby market known as Begum Bazaar. Managing stock is one of the key aspect but there is no solid mechanism to track the same.

There are no books of account being maintained by Mr. Ahmad. Since he trusts a lot on his staff and consider them as his brother, he never felt the need of keeping a track of material and money coming in and going out. In his words, ***"Ye sab jana apne bhai jaise hain, inse apne ko kaahe ka darr. Aur kyun account book maintain karna, bematlab ka likhi padhi hota hai"***

Mr. Ahmad uses the most of the income for the business purpose only. On asking, about a situation of getting a higher than normal profit unexpectedly, Mr. Ahmad said that he will invest that money into the business only. ***"Byaaz toh hamaare religion mein waise bhi haram hai, Bank mein 10,000 Jama karke 400 Rs. Kamaane se acchha business me laga de, naya maal leke aur zyada kama sakte"***

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

The key risks that exist for Mr. Ahmad includes:

- Rapidly changing designs of material
- Low margin

Other than the above challenges, there are no major issues in the business. To tackle the above two challenges, Mr. Ahmad have to keep a close eye on the changing needs of the customer and updating market scenarios. On the margin front, it is very difficult to increase it and there is no existing solution with Mr. Ahmad. However, as a backup plan, Mr. Ahmad is thinking of starting the stitching businesses it will give higher margin.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Mr. Ahmad has both a current as well as a savings account. He is also in the process of taking a loan from the United Bank of India. Usage of savings account however is low. Mr Ahmad, instead of saving in Bank account, is putting the money in the Chitti. He has also taken funds from chitti once to repay the loan of his brother of 50,000 Rs. He is unaware about government schemes for finance needs and non-financial needs of entrepreneurs.

Mr. Ahmad is using no other banking product.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Mr. Ahmad is well aware of the digital payment channels. He accepts the payments from most of the online payment modes except through PoS machine. At present, around 90% of the transaction is cash based at his shop. Mr. Ahmad learnt using the digital payment app with help of agents of these payment apps. Mr. Ahmad also uses the WhatsApp for the placement of order and at the same time he sends the photos to some of the customers of the available design for the sales purpose. He also sees videos on YouTube.

Past learning experience and training support required

Though Mr. Ahmad never attended any training before to improve his business, he thinks that a training on account maintenance will be helpful in case we expand the business and the number of transactions increases. He is also willing to be trained on increase the income in the business quickly.
Mr. Ahmad is comfortable in both classroom and video mode of learning. His preferred language is Hindi and the preferred video format is in the form of cartoons. He has no much issues with the time duration as long as he can see after pause.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Mr. Ahmad is not willing to share the personal data as he thinks that it will lead to fraud. He has no much issues in sharing the business data.

Session 28

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Sheikh Abdul Fadir
Gender	Male
Age	55
Education	Class 5th passed
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2 Children: 5
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Trading
Bank account ownership	Stationery shop also selling gift items, toys
Type of mobile phone	Smartphone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 120,000 - 150,000
Category of respondent	3

Business establishment

Sheikh Abdul lives in Karmik Nagar locality of Yousufguda area in Hyderabad. He owns three houses and a shop in the same locality. He lives with his family in one of the houses, and the other two houses have been given on rent. He runs a stationery cum gift items shop. The shop was redeveloped few months ago and presently, is being stocked with more items.
Sheikh Abdul used to live in Saudi Arabia, where he owned a small convenience store. His family moved back to India in the year 2000 while he came back in 2009, the major reason being - he always wanted to settle down in India. After coming back, he started investing heavily in the real estate business but due to some fraud where he lost money to the tune of INR 2.5 million, he stopped investing in this business. He started doing the business of selling stationery and gift items from the year 2010 from his house. The shop where he shifted his business used to be very small and was given on rent for INR 2,000. He and his elder son decided to use the shop for their business as the rental income from the shop was hardly anything and felt that a fixed shop (instead of selling from their house) will give them greater access to the market and the customers. The shop was rebuilt in the span of 3 months and very recently - the painting, electricity wiring, and decoration work got completed. Abdul said of using his personal savings in shop's redevelopment. The shop is registered with GHMC.

Managing business activities

When asked about how the decision of starting a trading business that too a stationery shop was taken – Abdul thought of opening a convenience store similar to what he had in Saudi Arabia but that business was capital intensive and required large investments. Abdul says, 'this is an easy business, always in demand, you only need to bring and resale the products' about the stationery, gift items business. Abdul and his elder son who is a graduation first year student and also helps his father in the shop are currently managing the shop. The prior experience of running a successful business (convenience store) in Saudi Arabia has helped him to run this business as well, he says. The stationery items, gifts, toys and other products are purchased from the nearby markets such as Hussainganj. Every 10 days or so the shop has to be restocked with the products which are selling higher or are in greater demand. For all the purchases, Abdul makes cash payments. He also saves on going and buying the products himself rather than getting the products supplied at his doorstep. None of the sellers accept digital payments, cheques or online money transfer, says Abdul.
The daily turnover of his business varies but is mostly around INR 3,000-5,000 per day. *'Jab school, college khulta hai (new session) tab zyda demand rehta hain'*. The margin on the products is somewhere in the range 30-40%. Since the shop is owned and managed by Abdul and his son, the only business expense is of electricity that is around INR 2,500 per month.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

Abdul said of not facing any risk or challenge in the running the business. As per him the stationery items, gifts and toys are always in demand and these are the things which hardly go out of fashion. On toys and gift items he takes suggestions from the sellers and tries to understand items which are in greater demand. The area in which Abdul's shop is located is a slum area where people hardly make online orders through the websites such as – amazon, flipkart, etc. These online sellers have hardly affected his business.

He had a bad experience of doing ROSCA/Becci 'called Chitti in Hyderabad' where after 2 years he got lesser amount than what he had actually contributed (the difference amount was charged as commission by the person who manages chitti). Abdul stopped being part of such chittis' from that point of time. Clearly shows loss aversion bias as the lump sum on demand - the most important reason why many people save in chitti is not important for him, rather he wants appreciated returns.

Access and usage levels of banking products

He is having a savings bank account with Allahabad Bank. This is an old account (was opened many years ago) and is used mainly to save surplus money from the business from time to time. However, his major focus is on business expansion and on adding more and more stocks and new type of items. He has a small FD maintained with Post Office. He has not subscribed to any insurance scheme. Her youngest daughter which is 10 years old was enrolled under Sukanya Smaridhi Yojana, which was initiated by her school, he only made the payments as required under the scheme. Abdul was not aware about the policy and benefits of the scheme.
Abdul has applied for a loan with United Bank of India, his application is under review stage. His brother took a loan from the same bank, he was the one who informed him about the loan policy and rate of interest and introduced him to SubK field staff. His application is under review stage with the bank.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Abdul has a smartphone which he has been using for more than 2 years. He uses Whatsapp only for chatting with his friends and relatives, and not for business purposes.
Digital payment acceptance - Agents from Paytm, PhonePe came to his shop and on-boarded him on both the apps, they also gave him a small standee with QR code with the name of the shop written over it. The PhonePe guy helped him to download the application on his phone, link his bank account and explained the basic navigation within the app. A very small number of the customers make payment through these apps but Abdul

doesn't see any loss in having these - as the services are free and since the PhonePe app is linked to his bank account, the amount gets directly deposited into his account. His son is well versed is using these apps. 'Zyada youngsters hi karte hain Paytm', says Abdul

His son does usage of digital payments - The electricity bill payment and mobile recharges through these apps. Apart from this, he doesn't see any other use case for these applications. He also has an ATM card linked to the bank account, he knows how to use it but it is his elder son who mostly makes the withdrawals on his behalf. Abdul is not using internet banking, mobile banking applications.

Past learning experience and training support required

Abdul says whatever he learnt while running the business in Saudi Arabia is helping him in running the stationery and gift items business. He said of doing record keeping and also showed us the dairy where he records day wise purchases and sales. He also keeps the purchase related bills properly, he doesn't issue bills as most of the sales are of smaller amounts and also his customers hardly ask him for bills. However, he showed interest in getting trainings on - methods of proper recordkeeping as this would benefit him in longer run, he feels. He is more interested in classroom based training than videos. He says, at the classroom based training sessions, he would be able to discuss the problems/challenges with others, can get his queries resolved at the same time which is not possible in case of videos. He would be able to take out sometime as his son can take care of the shop in his absence. The preferred time for such sessions was during afternoon. He would any day prefer the trainings to be done in Hindi than Telgu as he is more comfortable in Hindi. He is aware about commonly used digital payment applications. Abdul could not think of any other area/skill set on which he would like to get trained.
The expansion plan for his business is to purchase a xerox machine, start selling school bags, other items required by the students – bottles, tiffins'. He will utilize the loan in buying these things only.

Willingness to share personal and business data

He is fine with sharing his personal or business related information but firstly he will try to understand why the information being collected, how and for what purposes it will be used.

Session 29

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban, Rehmath Nagar
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Ms. Geeta
Gender	Female
Age	42
Education	Graduate
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 2
Business is primary income source	No
Business type	Services + Trading: Stitching, Matching Centre
Bank account ownership	Account with IOB and Andhra Bank
Type of mobile phone	Smart Phone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 50,000
Category of respondent	1

Business establishment

Ms. Geeta started her business 6 years ago. To start this business, she had borrowed some amount of money from her relatives. Before starting this business, she used to give coaching of stitching and tailoring to young girls. The initial 1-2 years were not very profitable and her sales were in the range of INR 25000-35000 per month. Later on it picked up as the customers get to know about her shop and some of them became regular customers. The husband of Geeta is a dealer of sanitary items and he support her in outdoor activities as well. There are two employees at the shop and they support Geeta in completing the orders quickly.

Managing business activities

Geeta is managing her business with the help of 2 other staff members. Almost 60-70% of the customers are repeat customers. The daily earnings are in the range of INR 1500-2000 with a margin of 40-50% on each product. The major expenses of Geeta is the salary of staff (INR 7000 per month) and rent (INR 5000).

The shop is registered with GHMC (Greater Hyderabad Municipal Corporation). Geeta has also taken a loan recently of INR 0.15 Million from United Bank through SubK. She is planning to expand.

There are no books of account being maintained by Geeta. She is the one who manages all the money matters and the employees are not involved in billing and other financial activities. In her words, ***"Pehle Hisaab rakhte the jab shop employee ke bharose chalti thi kabhi kabhi. Ab toh pura din mai hi rehti hu toh hissab nahi rakhte. Bus Kaccha bill kaat dete hain."***

Geeta uses the most of the income for the business purpose only. On asking, about a situation of getting a higher than normal profit unexpectedly, Geeta said that she will invest that money into the business only. She wants to own a shop one day as she thinks that the rent is an unnecessary expense. On a monthly basis, she is able to save INR 20,000 to 25,000.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

The key risks/challenges that exist for Geeta includes:

- Poor shop location
- Rapidly changing designs and styles
- Fast turnaround as customers want the delivery quickly

Other than the above challenges, there are no major issues in the business. To tackle the above two challenges, Geeta have to keep a close eye on the changing designs and styles. Also, she visits the market regularly from where she purchases the material.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Geeta has two savings account. She has also taken a loan from the United Bank of India. She invest the money in small chit funds and gives out INR 5000 every month for the same. It is a 20-member group chit fund. She is very well aware of using ATM and have also withdrawn the cash in the past.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Geeta is well aware of the digital payment channels. She accepts the payments from most of the online payment modes except through PoS machine. At present, around 80% of the transaction is cash based at her shop. Despite of multiple online payment options, she uses the Paytm most as she finds the Paytm interface more user friendly. Geeta also uses the WhatsApp for the placement of order and at the same time sends the photos to some of the customers of the available design for the sales purpose. Her digital journey had started with Youtube and now she is using digital payment apps and social media apps for the business purposes.

Past learning experience and training support required

Geeta herself was a trainer earlier but she never attended any training on improving the business skills. She is not sure about any training requirement at present. However, her preferred mode is video based training in Hindi. She wants to see the real people for explaining the concepts and don't want any animated video as it will look fake. Lunch hour is the best time for her to watch videos.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Geeta has no issues in sharing personal or business information.

Session 30

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	MK Pravin Kumar
Gender	Male
Age	29
Education	Intermediate, pursuing graduation (in first year)
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2 Children: 0
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Services
Bank account ownership	Tent house
Type of mobile phone	Smartphone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 30,000 – 60,000
Category of respondent	1

Business establishment

Pravin Kumar lives in a joint family in Yousufguda area. Pravin ventured into the tent house business in the year 2009. The initial capital of INR 100,000 was provided to him by his father. Before starting this business, he used to work as a delivery boy for a private company delivering the products sold by the company to the shops. The job was not paying him well that is why he thought of starting a business. There were no tent houses in that area

when he started the business. The initial capital was used to purchase the materials such as utensils, floor mats, curtains, etc.

Managing business activities

Pravin along with two staff manages the business. The business is seasonal in nature – high demand during festivals, marriages, and lower demands during the remaining part of the year. During lean period the monthly turnover is around INR 30,000 while during peak season the turnover is around INR 50,000-60,000 per month. The monthly business expenses range somewhere between INR 15,000-25,000. Two years back Pravin took a loan of INR 50,000 from Capital First for purchasing more materials. The loan is fully repaid now. They were offering him bigger loan but he said no to it - as the rate of interest was very high (told us that for the loan of INR 50,000 he paid almost INR 73,000). The business is registered with GHMC.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

Major risk is of covering costs during the lean period, as even if he doesn't gets business he has to make payments for the fixed costs such as godown, rent, and salary to staff, electricity bill, etc.

Also, the other risk is of not receiving the payments from the customers' on-time. Some of the customers' have also defaulted on his payments.

Access and usage levels of banking products

Pravin has savings bank account with two banks SBI (older account) and UBI (to receive the recent loan from SubK-UBI). He said of regularly saving in his SBI bank account (INR 5,000-8,000 per month). As he lives in a joint family, most of the household expenses are met from his mother's pension and a small grocery shop which is managed by his younger brother.

He also has credit card which he uses for making personal purchases like cloths, making payments for leisure activities such as restaurant bills, movies, etc. Pravin took a loan from UBI of INR 200,000 to expand his business by purchasing more materials, so that he can take bigger orders or can serve at multiple locations at the same time.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

He has a smartphone and uses different apps such as Whatsapp, Facebook, Paytm, PhonePe, Google Pay. He receives payments from his customers though Paytm/PhonePe but doesn't use these to make business related payments. All the payments related to his business are made in cash. *'Ab customer ko jaise bhi paise dena hai main le leta hun'*. The amount received from customer through these apps automatically gets transferred into his bank account and when needed he makes withdrawal using ATM card. He receives and confirms order using Whatsapp. Facebook is for personal purpose only. He never thought of using Facebook for marketing, promoting his business.

Past learning experience and training support required

Running a tent business doesn't requires any specific skills, says Pravin. Further, he said of maintaining records of the transactions – orders, payments received, amount due, etc.

He was very particular about the rate of interest charged by different institutions on the loans – he said of receiving SMSs from banks, other FIs and analyzing it over to find the most suitable option. Very recently he become a member of a chitti consisting of 20 members including him with each one of them contributing INR 5,000 per month. He knows the person who is managing the chitti and is quite confident that this is safe option for placing surplus money - *[Social default bias – he is copying decisions made by his friends' as he is not able to make any informed decisions]* He said of not requiring any specific training on aspects related to business, financial management, etc. Rather, he was more interested in knowing if job oriented trainings such as beautician course can be provided to his wife.

Willingness to share personal and business data

He is not comfortable in sharing his personal or business related information with anyone.

Session 31

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban, Rehmath Nagar
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Mr. Mohammad Maqbool
Gender	Male
Age	48
Education	12th Pass
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 2
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Trading: Shoe/handbag shop
Bank account ownership	Account with Syndicate Bank
Type of mobile phone	Smart Phone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 60,000
Category of respondent	2

Business establishment

Mr. Maqbool started his business 5 years ago. Before that, he was into the transportation line and working as an employee at a private firm. He left that job due to low salary. To setup and start this business, he had borrowed some amount of money from his relatives and friends. He had also taken some loan against gold from informal sources. Mr. Maqbool had no knowledge of running a business on his own when he started this business and hence he faced some initial struggles.

Managing business activities

Mr. Maqbool is managing the business activities on his own. There is no other staff member or employee in the shop. He goes in the market as per the need and refill the stock. The daily revenue is around INR 2000. There are shoes, handbags and clothes available in the shop.

There are no books of account being maintained by Mr. Maqbool. He says that since he is alone in the shop, there is no need of writing every small piece of information and transactional activities.

The only major expense item is rent of the shop, which is INR 4000. The margin on an average is 30-40% and on a daily basis, Mr. Maqbool is able to save INR 600-700. Recently, in order to increase the stock, Mr. Maqbool has also taken a loan from united bank.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

- The only challenge quoted by Mr. Maqbool is low margin. Some of the relatives and friends of Mr. Maqbool also ask for high discount, which he has had to give. These were the only pain areas for Mr. Maqbool.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Mr Maqbool visits the bank branch once in every 15 days. He is aware about banking processes. He has a savings account. To withdraw cash, he also goes to the ATM, as and when needed.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

In case of use of digital infrastructure for business, Mr Maqbool has limited options. He prefers "PhonePe" app over others. There is no PoS machine or google pay option available. Though Mr Maqbool has no problem in accepting digital payments, almost 95% of the total sales is in cash.

Past learning experience and training support required

In past, Mr. Maqbool had never attended any training. On asking about the need of training, he said that ***"Hum bade business man hote to theek tha but hamaare jaise chhote business man ke liye koi fayda nahi"***.
He has made no recommendation on the type and mode of training.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Mr. Maqbool can share business information but he denied to share personal information.

Day 3 (12th June, 2019)

Session 32

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Vanasthalipuram, Urban
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Chandishwer
Gender	Male
Age	40
Education	Intermediate
No. of members in the family	Wife and three children
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Trading; Electricals, and other civil work related
Bank account ownership	Current and savings both
Type of mobile phone	Smartphone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 15,00,000-20,00,000
Category of respondent	4

Business establishment

Chandishwer started this shop in 5 years back in 2014. Before this he used to work as plumber for 15 years. The initial capital of INR 500,000 was made through the funds he received from ROSCA/Chitti which he had been doing for more than 10 years. 5 years back there was no such shop in that area. This prompted he to start with the shop. The shop used to be small but with time he kept on adding more and more stocks.

Managing business activities

He is the one who is managing the shop. He is supported by two workers. The shop is rented, per month rent is INR 25,000 since it is located on the main road. The same shop not on the main road would have much lower rent but the customer footfall would also be less, says Chandishwer. Most of the products are supplied at door step by his supplier. Unbranded products are purchased from the market. Most of his supplier give him stocks on credit of 10-15 days. The payments are made in both cash and check. The shop is GST registered. His CA takes care of the tax related formalities. Almost 90 percent of the payments made by the customers are in cash, while remaining 10 percent through online modes. He accepts payments through Google Pay, PhonePe, Paytm. Daily sales range from INR 40,000-50,000. The margin on the products range from 5-15 percent.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

Chandishwer said of not facing any challenge as such. His vast experience of working as plumber and closely observing the electrical part requirements has helped him to start and run the shop.

Access and usage levels of banking products

Chandishwer opened his bank account with the intention to save. He used to save money irregularly when he was working as a plumber. More than saving with bank, he saved regularly in ROSCA/Chitti. The money saved at bank and from the amount received from Chitti, he was able to start his shop.

The loan provided by SubK-UBI is his first loan ever. He was in need of money for purchasing more stocks. One of his friend suggested him taking loan from SubK-UBI and gave him the number of the SubK staff.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Chandishewer said of using banking apps on his smartphone for making payments. He also accepts payments from customers through applications – Google Pay, PhonePe, Paytm. The agents from these companies came and helped him in getting on-boarded. Still the amount received through these apps is just 10 percent of total revenue.

Also, he said that the big companies such as Phillips, Anchor have develop applications which provides details on their latest products, prices. He uses these apps to get information. He was told by the agents of these companies about the apps. He is able to navigate the application on his own.

Past learning experience and training support required

He said of being very much occupied with his day to day business. He could not think of any training or support which can be provided to him. Complexities such as GST, taxation are handled by his CA.

Apart from the two workers there is no one who can manage the shop in his absence then also he prefers workshop/classroom mode of trainings over videos. In his opinion, videos won't help rather it is one on one conversations that help people like him to learn.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Not comfortable in sharing any data with us. He said of being comfortable in sharing data with financial institutions only.

Session 33

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Vanasthalipuram, Urban
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	N Anita
Gender	Female
Age	37
Education	Class 10th
No. of members in the family	Husband and two children
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Services; Tailoring and readymade garments sales
Bank account ownership	Yes
Type of mobile phone	Smartphone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 80,000-100,000
Category of respondent	2

Business establishment

N Anita's tailoring and readymade garment shop is 5 years old. She learnt the skill of tailoring long time back and when it was the right time to support and augments her family income, she started this shop. She got support from her husband, and brother in opening the shop. The initial capital was small and she brought it form her personal savings. She gets order from her customers and with time she has been able to maintain a pool of regular customers. The raw materials, stocks required to tailor the clothes are brought by her from the Begumpura market. All the payments are made in cash. She also outsources stitching work to other women living nearby.

Managing business activities

Anita is supported by two regular workers on the shop. Additionally, she outsources work to other women, whom she knows and is sure would complete the job is given time. The sales varies – during the festivals it gets much better as compared to lean season. The margin varies between 20-25 percent.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

Apart from usual business fluctuations, she said of not facing any major challenge. At times she gets complaints from customers about the quality of work or material which she then tries to sort out through rework. Currently, she is focusing on managing money to buy a piece of land and securing her kids future. Does a Chitti of INR 5,000 per month to manage the need of getting lump sum amount when needed.

Access and usage levels of banking products

She has a savings bank account with SBI, where she used to save earlier but currently with the increased household expenses she is not able to save regularly.
In past she took gold loan to purchase her house. The current loan from SubK-UBI is her first business loan. The loan was taken for purchasing additional stocks.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

She has a smartphone. The applications used on her phone are – Whatsapp, Facebook, and YouTube. People send her new designs on Whatsapp. Facebook and YouTube are used for entertainment purposes but sometimes she also looks for new designs on Youtube and also on Pinterest. She does not uses payments applications since none of her customer make or even ask for making payments through these apps. All the purchases and sales are in cash.
She is also part of group mostly having friends where they also discusses about sarees, fashions, and new designs

Past learning experience and training support required

She learnt the basic skills of tailoring and stitching long time back. Doesn't maintains proper records but would be happy to learn it.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Not willing to share any data. Gave the example where she gets SMS from bank asking not to share CVV, PIN with anyone.

Session 34

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Vanasthalipuram, Urban
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Vinod Kumar
Gender	Male
Age	40
Education	Intermediate
No. of members in the family	Wife and two kids
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Trading; General Store
Bank account ownership	Yes
Type of mobile phone	Smartphone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 500,000-600,000

Category of respondent	4

Business establishment

Vinod owns a shop in a residential locality in Vanasthalipuram area. His is the biggest general store in the area. His father also owns a general store, smaller compared to his in the same area. Vinod said of learning the business skills from his father only. He opened this shop 6 years back with support from his parents, personal savings and money brought from chitti. The initial investment was of INR 400,000.

Managing business activities

Vinod manages the shop alone. Most of the stock are delivered at door step by his suppliers, there are few items for which he goes to the market and makes purchases. Has Udyog Aadhaar for the shop and also the labor license. He procures 70 percent of the stocks through the distributors and rest 30 percent from the Udaan application. Agent of Udaan came to his shop and informed him about the application. In starting he was skeptical about using the application but once he tried, he gained confidence and started using the application regularly. His daily turnover is in range of INR 20,000-25,000. The margin on the products is 10-15 percent. He is also a Chitti agent. The per month amount is INR 100,000-200,000.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

No risk faced as such. He said of helping his brother to open a general store. By his way of speaking and conduct, Vinod appears to be a confident man, willing to take risks and capable of managing risky situations.
When given a situation where he earns a surplus – Vinod said of investing it in business rather than keeping it in his bank account.

Access and usage levels of banking products

Vinod opened his bank account with Andhra Bank almost 8 year back. There was no specific reason for getting the account opened.
Two years back he got a MUDRA loan of INR 100,000 from his bank which is fully repaid now. The loan with SubK-UBI is his second loan, the main purpose of borrowing was to purchase stock.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

He uses Whatsapp, Facebook, YouTube for entertainment purposes only. He said of using 'Udaan' application meant for shopkeeper like to make wholesale/bulk purchase of commodities. He trusts the app, he also shared an instance where low quality product was supplied by the vendor he contacted through the app, but alter on making complaint he got his money back.

Past learning experience and training support required

'Records wagarah important hain jahan partner hota hain', says Vinod when asked about bookkeeping. He feels, he knows everything required to run the business. Though he does not feel any need of training support but said, in case any trainings are provided it should be classroom based and not through videos. 1 hour long.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Not willing to share data

Session 35

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad

Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Vanasthalipuram, Urban
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Prithvi
Gender	Male
Age	29
Education	Post-Graduation
No. of members in the family	Wife
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Manufacturing; Bakery
Bank account ownership	Yes
Type of mobile phone	Smartphone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 125,000-150,000
Category of respondent	3

Business establishment

Prithvi was working in the IT industry. Some family problems made him leave his job and start some business, so that he can focus on his family while working. His father is into catering business, so the most appropriate choice was getting into bakery line. Prithivi started by hiring chefs/bakers who knew the in and out of the bakery business. He is supported by his uncle t whom he pays a monthly salary.

Managing business activities

He along with his uncle manages the shop. He personally ensures that the quality of the products are maintained and there is no compromise on that aspect. His daily revenue varies from INR 5,000-8,000. The margin averages between 30-40 percent.

Situations – What he will do with the surplus money of INR 10,000 – He will invest it into the business, the returns are higher as compared to saving it in the bank.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

Quality of the product and ensuring labor is the main risk he sees in the business. He has seen businesses suffering because of quality degradation when the bakers/chefs changed. Thus, he has to keep his labors happy and ensure that they keep on working at his bakery.

Also, he keeps taking suggestions from the customers on taste and new food items they would like his shop to offer. Based on the feedback he started offering Chinese food items on his shop. He feels customer feedback is important for a business like his

Access and usage levels of banking products

He has a bank account. He currently said of not saving. All his family members have insurances,. He feels insurances are very important to meet emergency situations.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Using the different digital payment options on his phone both for personal as well as business purposes. He has got his shop listed with online food delivery apps like Zomato and Swiggy. He said of showing videos on YouTube to his cooks for designing cakes, pastry items. They are able to learn and quickly adopt the designs after seeing the videos.

Past learning experience and training support required

Since, he had very different background, so while deciding the type of business, he went around different bakery shops and tried to understand the business – products, raw materials, labor issues, registration, license

requirements, etc. from them. His suggestion is, if Accion can provide such informations inform of trainings to people like him who are looking to start something new. He is more willing to have videos as compared to classroom because people like him are busy and it would be tough for time to go and attend such trainings. He feels people won't be interested in paying for such videos.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Not willing to share any data or information with us.

Session 36

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Vanasthalipuram, Urban
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Venkat
Gender	Male
Age	32
Education	Intermediate
No. of members in the family	Wife and a kid
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Services; DTH service, recharges
Bank account ownership	Yes
Type of mobile phone	Smartphone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 500,000-600,000
Category of respondent	4

Business establishment

Venkat's shop is 6 years old. Before starting this shop he used to work as DTH technician and mobile repair. He has attended many trainings on repairing mobile phones and even now he does crash course on the new technologies or repairing new type of mobile phones available in the market. His shop is GST registered.

Managing business activities

Has 3 staff for DTH installation and service. Though the DTH connection purchased from his shop is costly as compared if someone directly procures it from the company. The benefit he offers is of service. The installation and repair services provided by him are very prompt and less costly than provided by the company.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

The only risk is of online businesses. Both in DTH and recharges, he has lost business. His mitigation strategy is providing best possible service to the clients even if his margins/earnings are low.

Access and usage levels of banking products

Has both current and savings bank account. Has got two m-POS machines from UBI bank and Paytm.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Uses almost all the digital payment applications. Also, uses one application – OK credit to remind people who own him money of payments due.

Past learning experience and training support required

He likes videos and says these are more suitable as can be seen anytime as per the viewer's convenience. 'Cartoon is interesting'. 'Preferred it in the local language. Liked the animated videos more than anything. He would like to get support on financial management, book keeping issues. He know pretty well about marketing and customer service side of the business.

Day 4 (13th June, 2019)

Session 37

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Ms. Swaroopa
Gender	Female
Age	35+
Education	10th Pass
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 2
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Trading: Utensils
Bank account ownership	Yes- Savings and credit account
Type of mobile phone	Smart Phone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 150,000-300,000
Category of respondent	3

Business establishment

The shop is 20 years old, however Swaroopa is managing this business since last 8 years. She is supported by her husband as well who manages all the outdoor activities of the business. Before managing this business, Swaroopa had also learnt stitching for 3 months. She says that since tailoring business is not as profitable as trading of utensil, she decided not to start stitching business. There is a total investment of INR 0.5 million in the shop. Ms. Swaroopa and her husband have also taken a loan of INR 50,000 in 2015 for the business purposes.

Managing business activities

Swaroopa and her husband, both are managing the business activities together. There is no other staff member or employee in the shop. Husband of Swaroopa goes in the market as per the need and refill the stock. The daily revenue is around INR 5000-10,000. The daily revenue usually gets doubled in the marriage season. Along with selling new items, they also purchase old utensils from customers.

Swaroopa does not maintain any books of account. The shop is on rent and the monthly rent of INR 4000 is being paid by Swaroopa. The margin on the products varies from 10 to 15%. There are good number of repeat customers who visit the shop in regular intervals.

Swaroopa wish to own a showroom someday for her utensils business and the approximate cost for it will be INR 2 Million. She is working hard and managing both the business and her family simultaneously. In case of extra earnings, she will put the money in her savings account in the bank as she thinks that she may need it in future for some emergency.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them

There are some personal challenges that are being faced by Ms. Swaroopa. One of her son is not physically fit and hence she gives extra attention to him. This makes it difficult for her to manage home and shop. On the business front, there are no such major issues.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Swaroopa has a savings account in the Telangana bank and she also save some amount of money in the bank every month. She also invests in chit funds where there are 20 members. She usually gives INR 12000-25000 per month in the chit funds. She had also once withdrawn the money from her chit fund for the construction of house. As they have also taken the loan, they are very well aware about the requirement of documents and processes for availing the credit from the bank.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Ms Swaroopa accepts digital payments and her favourite platforms are Tezz and Paytm. Out of the total revenue in a month, approximate 10-15% comes through digital mode. She also uses whatsapp for business related talks and chat with her supplier for her requirement.

Past learning experience and training support required

In past, Ms Swaroopa had never attended any training. However, she thinks that a training on business aspects will be helpful for her. Her preferred mode of training is through videos and she want to see real people as actor and not the animated characters. She wants the length of the video to be as short as 10 Minutes. The language requested by her is Telugu.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Ms. Swaroopa has denied to share any kind of information- whether personal or business, until we provide proper clarification on the need of information.

Session 38

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses

State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban, Manikonda
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Vinila (accompanied by her husband)
Gender	Female
Age	33
Education	MBA
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including herself Children: 1
Business is primary income source	Husband is doing Job
Business type	Manufacturing & Trading (Handicraft, personal care, cosmetic)
Bank account ownership	Owner and her husband both have personal savings account; One current account in the name of business
Type of mobile phone	Smart Phone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 120,000
Category of respondent	3

Business establishment

Ms. Vinila, a modern day entrepreneur is a well-educated lady with a master's degree in business administration. She started her business of hand crafted bangles, branded cosmetic and personal care items in 2017, i.e. two years back from today. Before this business, Ms. Vinila used to work in a private firm. But, due to some challenges in life, Ms. Vinila had to quit her job. The main reason for leaving her job was personal health issues and also her responsibilities towards family. She is the mother of a daughter, who is also suffering from some health related problems.

Since, Ms. Vinila was always inclined towards creativity (She used to make paintings in her free time as well) and wanted to do something innovative, she came to a conclusion to start something of her own where these skills can be utilized. However, the idea of starting a business came after several discussions between Ms. Vinila and her husband. Before commencing the business. Ms. Vinila did some market research and mystery shopping, just to understand the customer needs and expectations.

In the words of Ms. Vinila, **"Establishing a business after leaving a fixed time job was a challenge but with the support of my husband and my sister in law, I was able to turn it around."**

The total initial investment was INR 500,000. The INR 100,000 was arranged by Ms. Vinila and her husband with the help of their personal savings and the rest of INR 400,000 were borrowed from relatives. Ms. Vinila also told that the first 5 months of the business were not good and they were not able to sell much. But later on, they found stability in the business and today they are also selling some of the handmade items, outside of the city.

Managing business activities

Ms. Vinila manages the shop as her husband is working in a private form full time. Ms. Vinila also get some support from a helper who works at the shop. The daily average sales are INR 4000 and it fluctuates between 3000 to 6000. The margin on the items are different and it is as low as 20% on branded items but on other self-made items and artificial jewelry products, it is as high as 100%. The average margin comes out as 60%.
Other than sales, major expense items are rent and light bill. The total rent on the shop is INR 14,000 and the light bill on an average is around INR 1,000.

Ms. Vinila manages the stock herself and with the help of her husband. Some of the items are being bought from outside market of Hyderabad as well. In order to meet additional business requirement of managing inventory and expenses, Ms. Vinila has also taken a loan of INR 200,000 from United Bank of India recently. The idea of taking the loan was given to her by her husband.

Ms. Vinila maintains her books of account constantly and note down all the sales record in a notebook. Ms. Vinila and her husband are also planning to use some software or digital platform to keep a track of income and expenses.

Hypothetical situation:

1. **In case of a sudden and more than normal profit**- Ms. Vinila and her husband has a difference of opinion in case of sudden profit (more than usual). Ms. Vinila wants to save that extra earning for her daughter in a bank account which can be exclusively used for her daughter's future. On the other hand, the husband of Ms. Vinila wants to expand the business with the help of that extra earning.

2. **Marketing strategy in case of an upcoming festival which happens rarely (once in 10 years):** To attract more number of customers, Ms. Vinila will try to attract the customers using below methods:
    - She will display the items in a stall outside the shop and near the festival place
    - She will distribute the visiting cards of her shop to the people
    - She will show multiple items, even if the customer asks for any specific item
    - She will also offer to deliver the items directly at home of the customers (in case of advance payment)

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

The major challenges considered by Ms. Vinila are:

- Lack of money to support day to day business activities and expansion
- Managing family (daughter is unwell) and business altogether
- Customers asking for reduced prices and discounts after comparing the prices with online marketplace

Ms. Vinila faces a lot of challenges in managing her time as she has to work on the hand made products as well. She goes to the shop on a daily basis as it cannot be dependent on the worker only. The bad health of the daughter also poses some challenges for Ms. Vinila as her daughter requires some extra attention and time. On

facing challenges, Ms. Vinila says, ***"With the help of my husband, I am able to manage all my challenges till now. He is my best support system. Other than him, my sister in law and her husband are also supporting us and we speak to them in case of any difficulty."***

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Ms Vinila and her husband, both are having personal savings account. There is also a current account for business transactions. They use cheque in some cases to pay to their suppliers. They have also taken an insurance which covers the full family. Since the owner and her husband are well educated, they are fully aware about the banking products and major terms and conditions.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

In overall transactions at the shop, almost 70% of the transactions are cash based whereas 20% are online transactions. Rest of the 10% transactions are cheque based. The shop is having a PoS machine as well and some customers also pays through card. The google pay and Paytm are some of the payment wallets that are being used by the customers to pay at the shop as well. The preferred mode of accepting payment for Ms Vinila is cash or google pay app. Paytm on the other hand has also given INR 15,000 credit limit to Ms Vinila for the business. There is also an Udaan app which is being used by Ms Vinila, this app helps her to connect more than 20,000 traders across India. Both Ms Vinila and her husband are somewhat aware about the digital interfaces that can be used in running the business with ease.

Past learning experience and training support required

Ms Vinila and her husband has never attended any training before on business related concepts. Ms Vinila feels that a training on following topics can be helpful:

- How to reach large number of customers effectively
- How to improve in managing business
- Best app for online record keeping
- How to improve entrepreneurial skill
- Success stories and life journey of small entrepreneurs
- How to overcome the bargaining problem
- Effective cost management
- How to reach trustworthy wholesalers
- How to grow business effectively

Mode of training: Ms Vinila feels that 1-2 days of workshop (classroom training) on above topics will be better. However, both the Ms Vinila and her husband feels that videos are also fine as long as they are interesting and short in length.

Language: English or Telugu

Character: Cartoon characters are preferred in the video by Ms Vinila as she does not like the change in face expression of real actors, it makes her sad.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Ms Vinila and her husband are not ready to share any personal details like Aadhaar or Pan card. They are fine with sharing non-confidential business related details.

Session 39

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban, Manikonda
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Mr. Shiv Shankar Sharma
Gender	Male
Age	34
Education	Graduate
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Trading: Material used for worship
Bank account ownership	Yes- Savings and credit account
Type of mobile phone	Smart Phone
Monthly revenue from business	Average around INR 400,000 per branch (4 Branches)
Category of respondent	4

Business establishment

The business was being setup by Mr. Sharma 7 years ago after the completion of his graduation and some years of practice of worshipping in the temples. Mr. Sharma has studied the Sanskrit for 12 years and he knows each and every details necessary to perform the act of worship. To utilize his knowledge, he had setup this business with an initial investment of INR 0.7 Million. Within the 7 years, his business has done so well that he now has total 4 branches across Hyderabad. All the shops are nearby the temple area and have 1 to 2 employees managing the business. 3 shops are in the name of Mr. Sharma and 1 shop is in the name of his wife. He is planning to further open more branches at different locations.

Managing business activities

Mr. Sharma is managing all the 4 branches by himself. He usually visits each branch on different days but most of the time is given to the latest opened branch. His wife also sits in one of the four branches. However, to track the dealings in the transparent manner, there are CCTV cameras in all the 4 branches and it is monitored by Mr. Sharma from his phone. In case of any doubt, the employees call up Mr. Sharma and confirm the same.

All the shops are rented and on an average the rent is around INR 30,000. As an average, each of the shop earns a revenue of INR 400,000 monthly. The average margin on the products is around 30-40%. Mr. Sharma is very particular about the products he sells. He buys the brass items directly from Moradabad and other items from the best possible places nearby Hyderabad. There is seasonality in sales as well. During the peak season (August to December), the sales is normally double as compared to non-season.

Mr. Sharma does not maintain any books of account separately. However, there is a billing machine which records all the items being sold from the shop. All the items have a code and bills are generated after putting the code of the sold item. All the purchases made by Mr. Sharma are not recorded separately but he takes the bill for each item purchased and later give it his auditor/Chartered accountant for filing the taxes. Mr. Sharma manages the inventory with the help of the same machine as he takes out a print out at the end of the day and it shows the name and code of the item along with quantity sold.

Hypothetical Situations:

- In case of more than usual profit: Mr. Sharma will invest the extra profit into the business
- Training provided in the nearby area: Mr. Sharma does not feel the need of the training and hence he will not attend the same
- Supplier disallow credit: Mr. Sharma will buy the items and pay through check or will look out for a bigger supplier who offers credit

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them

Some of the challenges highlighted by Mr. Sharma are:

- Quick arrangement of investment amount for the opening of a new branch
- Buying the right material, from the right place, at the right price

There are no other major risks or challenges faced by Mr. Sharma.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Mr. Sharma has a high usage of banking products. He has four different current accounts for all four branches. He has saving accounts in different banks as well. He normally deposits the money in the bank, once in a month. There is a home loan running in his name as well. He has taken loan for business purpose as well from different banks/NBFCs (INR 400,000 from Kotak, 200,000 from UBI and 400,000 from Bajaj Finance). Mr Sharma also have multiple credit cards and he uses them for leisure activities and also for business sometimes. He also purchases gold for savings instead of putting cash in the bank. Mr. Sharma also have insurance of shop. There is a medical insurance policy as well in his name.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Mr. Sharma is very advanced as far as the use of digital infrastructure is concerned for business purpose. All of his branches have a POS machine. 20-30% of the sales is in cash form and the rest is online. Only the items which are very cheap in price and low in quantity are being purchased against cash. Mr. Sharma is using digital payment options such as Paytm from last 18 months. He is also using Google Pay and Phone Pay from last 6 months. Minimum amount of INR 100 is required in case a customer wants to pay via card. Mr. Sharma also uses mobile banking to pay for the purchases.

Past learning experience and training support required

Mr Sharma has never attended any sort of training in the past. As a general feedback, he personally does not feel that a training is required. However, in case he gets interested, his preferred mode of training will be through

videos of not more than 2-3 min. He prefers cartoons as compared to real characters in the video as he think that if someone is taking money for acting, he is not doing it from his heart and it's not natural.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Mr. Sharma is fine with sharing the business data but he will not share any personal details such as Aadhaar card or Pan Card.

Session 40

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban, Manikonda
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Ms. Jyoti (Partnership business)
Gender	Female
Age	45
Education	Primary
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 2
Business is primary income source	Yes (Husband is also running a tea stall- nearby)
Business type	Services: Food/Tiffin
Bank account ownership	Yes- Savings and credit account
Type of mobile phone	Smart Phone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 90,000
Category of respondent	2

Business establishment

Jyoti is running the business of tiffin services in the area since last 10 years. She came in the city with her husband 16 years ago from a village in Telangana. Husband of Jyoti had started a tea stall and later on to support her husband, Jyoti started a business of business of tiffin services with one of her partner. The tiffin service business is a 50-50 partnership between Jyoti and her colleague. They divided the daily earnings at the end of the day in half.

Managing business activities

Jyoti manages her daily business activities with the help of her partner. They have a regular set of customers. However, approximate 30-40% customers are new each day. Jyoti and her partner buys the food items such as vegetable, wheat and rice from the nearby market. All the expenses are divided in half between Jyoti and her partner. The shop, from where they are running the business is a rented space and they pay a rent INR 5000 per month. The overall margin is approximate 50% and Jyoti is able to earn (income- after margin) INR 700-800 every day after removing daily expenses.
Jyoti also manages her family and have two kids who are studying in the school.

Jyoti and her partner does all the calculations mentally and they are not keeping any books of account at the moment. They are doing this from last 10 years and hence very comfortable in their own method of calculations.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them

Uneven business is a challenge for Jyoti. Other than that, she does not think that there is any issue.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Jyoti has a savings account in the Karur Vyasya Bank and she deposit some amount of her savings every month in that account. She has also taken a gold loan from Andhra Bank of INR 135,000 to buy a land. Though she is aware about banking processes, she is not very confident about it. Also, she has never used her ATM card for withdrawal of cash. Jyoti also saves in chit funds and invest INR 10,000-12,000 every month.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Jyoti has the option of taking money from the customers in the Paytm wallet but she is not very comfortable about it. The digital modes of payment are available at the shop yet it is not being used exhaustively by Jyoti and her partner. They prefer cash.

Past learning experience and training support required

In past, Jyoti has never attended a training on building business concepts. She is interested in knowing the success stories of other women entrepreneur but she thinks that there is no scope of expansion for her. Since she is getting older day by day, she thinks that her current capacity of food services is enough and she will not be able to cater more customers.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Jyoti does not want to disclose any of her personal or business data.

Session 41

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Urban, Manikonda
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Mr. Santosh
Gender	Male
Age	26
Education	10th Pass
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 1

Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Service- Food stall
Bank account ownership	No
Type of mobile phone	Feature Phone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 60,000
Category of respondent	2

Business establishment

Santosh has set up his stall 1 year back. He came from a village in Karnataka and started working with his maternal uncle. Later on he has borrowed INR 50,000 from his friends and relatives to set up this food stall. It is a temporary setup and he pays INR 30 per day to Gram Panchayat for his stall at the location. Santosh is married and also have a kid.

Managing business activities

The daily investment for setting up the stall with required food items is INR 1000-1500. Santosh is able to earn INR 2000-2500 every day. The margin is somewhere close to 50%. Whatever he saves, he sent it to his home in the village. His normal savings per month is close to INR 15,000.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them

The temporary set up is causing a risk when whether is not good. The uneven income is another major challenge in meeting the fix expenses.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Mr. Santosh is completely unaware about banking services. He does not have a bank account and all the money which he saves, he keeps it with himself in cash.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

As Santosh is using a feature phone, he is not aware of digital payment options. He seems to be digitally illiterate.

Past learning experience and training support required

Santosh has never attended any training before. He has no idea on the requirement of training since he is too occupied in his business and family. He said that he will be able to attend a classroom session.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Santosh was open in sharing business details, but a bit unsure about sharing the personal data.

Day 5 (14th June, 2019)

Session 42

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad, Narsingi
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Rural
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	M Suresh Goud
Gender	Male
Age	40
Education	10th Pass
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 3
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Trading: Mobile shop and recharge
Bank account ownership	Yes- Savings and credit account
Type of mobile phone	Smart Phone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 1,000,000
Category of respondent	4

Business establishment

Mr. Suresh started the shop 15 years ago. It was a trading business of CDs and DVDs. The business was started by him with an initial investment of INR 150,000. Later on, as the technology progresses and CDs and DVDs started to become obsolete from the market, Mr. Suresh ventured into the business of mobile phone sales & repair and prepaid phone recharges. This time again he invested INR 200,000. Before starting the business of repairing of mobile phones, Mr. Suresh had also taken a 3 months training.

Managing business activities

For managing the daily business activities, Mr. Suresh has two employees at the shop. The shop is GST registered and very well organized. The daily revenue varies from INR 25,000 to INR 40,000. The margin also varies on the products and it is 2% in case of mobile phone recharge and 10% on mobile phone sales. The major expense for Mr. Suresh is the rent which is INR 7000, paid every month.

Mr. Suresh maintains a proper book of account and he notes down all the items sold and purchased by him.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them

Some of the risks raised by Mr. Suresh are as below:

- Lower margins due to competition with the ecommerce websites
- Issues when customers enter wrong digits of the phone number required to be recharged
- Mobile phone repair- high customer side issues

To tackle the competition from the e-commerce websites, he also offers high discount on the mobile phones. This sometime results into very low margin (as low as 5%).

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Instead of savings into the bank account, Mr. Suresh is investing around INR 30,000 every month in the chit funds. He has a savings bank account in United Bank of India and had also taken loans in the past from ICICI Bank and Fullerton. There is current account as well in the name of the shop with the Andhra Bank. Mr. Suresh is very well aware of the banking processes and products. He has recently taken a loan of INR 200,000 for the stocking of mobile phones. Mr. Suresh also has an insurance policy from LIC of INR 200,000. The shop is also insured.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Mr. Suresh owns a smartphone and he is very well aware about the digital payment options available in the market. He himself offers multiple options to his customers to make payments. There is a PoS machine installed in the shop. Mr. Suresh also accepts payment via UPI, Google Pay, Phone Pay and Paytm.

Out of the total transactions at the shop, 70% are cash based. Mr. Suresh also uses social media apps such as WhatsApp for placing the order of mobile phones.

Past learning experience and training support required

Mr. Suresh has attended one technical training before on how to repair a mobile phone. Other than this, he has never attended any training on the business nuances. Though Mr. Suresh thinks that he does not need any training but as a general feedback, he believes that a video based training will be easier to reach the target entrepreneurs. He says, ***"Classroom training mein sabke saamene nahi pooch sakte, Darr lagta hai. Video hoga toh baar baar repeat karke dekh sakte hain aur doubt hone par saath waalon ko pooch bhi sakte hain."*** His preferred language for training is Hindi and the suggested video length is 10 Mins.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Mr. Suresh denied to share any kind of information- whether personal or business.

Session 43

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad, Narsingi
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Rural
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Narayan Singh
Gender	Male
Age	37
Education	Intermediate
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 3
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Trading: Sweet Shop
Bank account ownership	Yes- Savings Account
Type of mobile phone	Smart Phone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 75,000
Category of respondent	2

Business establishment

Mr. Narayan has opened this shop 6 years ago. He is originally from Rajasthan and shifted to Hyderabad in 2003. For the first 10 years, he worked as a helper in different restaurants and sweet shops. In 2013, he decided to start his own business, along with his brother. With an initial investment of INR 150,000, they laid the foundation of this shop.

Managing business activities

Both the brothers manage the business together. They make the sweets every day from midnight till early morning and then sell it the whole day. There is no other staff in the shop and in case of rush, they take the help from their kids. Everyday revenue varies from INR 2000 to INR 3000.

Mr. Narayan does not maintain any books of account. The shop is on rent and the monthly rent is INR 5000. The margin on the products, varies from 15 to 20%. As per Mr. Narayan, it has declined as compared to past and it is getting difficult each day to maintain an average margin of over 15%.

Mr. Narayan believes that the shop is not at the prime location and hence they are not able to make good amount of money. He wants to open a new shop in the city are near main road. In case of extra earnings, he will use the money for the business only.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them

The major challenges faced by Mr. Narayan are:

- Uneven sales
- High Wastage, as the items are perishable

On account of uneven sales, it is difficult for Mr. Narayan to plan the exact quantity of the products that he should manufacture each day so that it will not get wasted.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Mr. Narayan has never taken any loan for the business, however he has taken a loan for the house. He took this loan from a private bank as it was referred by his friend. In terms of savings, Mr. Narayan has a savings account in the South Indian Bank. There are no other saving avenues and also there is no insurance policy in the name of Mr. Narayan or the shop. Mr. Narayan is comfortable in using ATM for cash withdrawal and he also visits his bank branch once in every month.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

Mr. Narayan accepts digital payments through online wallets such as Paytm and PhonePay. The share of online payments is only 5-10% in overall monthly revenue. Most of the customers prefer to pay in cash as the items are not very expensive. Mr. Narayan is fine with both cash and online payment options and has no particular preference.

Past learning experience and training support required

In past, Mr. Narayan has never attended any training on managing the business. He thinks that there is no need of training since experience teaches you everything. He Said, ***"Hum toh Trained hain, Paisa Chahiye business ke liye bus"***. However, as a general feedback, his preferred mode of training is through videos in hindi or Marwadi.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Mr. Narayan denied to share any kind of information- whether personal or business.

Session 44

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Hyderabad, Narsingi
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Rural
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Md. Imaduddin
Gender	Male
Age	40
Education	Primary
No. of members in the family	Adult: 2, including himself Children: 4
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Trading: Shoe
Bank account ownership	Yes- Savings account
Type of mobile phone	Smart Phone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 150,000
Category of respondent	3

Business establishment

Before starting this business, Mr. Imaduddin used to work as a helper in a Sofa shop and a Shoe shop. After learning the nuances of shoe trading, he decided to open his own shop in 2006. He had taken a shop on rent and set up his business with an initial investment of INR 100,000. He had borrowed this money from his friend and relatives.

Managing business activities

Mr. Imaduddin has 4 kids, out of which 3 are sons and 1 daughter. The sons are helping him in the business, but not full time. All three sons are studying at either college or in school. There is no staff in the shop and all the sales and purchase is managed by Mr. Imaduddin himself. He buys the material from the local market. The shop has both branded as well as non-branded items. The margin on the branded items is usually at around 20-25% whereas the margin on the unbranded items is 40%. There is seasonality in the business and the sales almost gets double during the festival time (Dussehra, Diwali, Eid).

Mr. Imaduddin does not maintain any books of account. However, he maintains all the original bills and give it to his chartered accountant for filling the taxes. The shop is GST registered.

As far as the major expenses are concerned, the shop is on rent and the monthly rent of INR 8000 is being paid by Mr. Imaduddin. Also, the monthly light bill is an another expense item, which usually varies from INR 600 to 800.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them

There are no challenges as such pointed out by Mr. Imaduddin.

Access and usage levels of banking products, other savings

Mr. Imaduddin has savings account in two banks. He also saves in the chit finds. There is a LIC insurance in the name of his daughter. As far as the credit is concerned, he has never availed any credit from the bank. He says, ***"Islam mein ye allowed nahi hai, aur hamara bina loan ke manage ho jata hai. Log madad kar dete hain."***

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

The shop has the option of payment through UPI or Paytm as far as the digital payments is concerned. Mr. Imaduddin is also thinking of taking a PoS machine so that people can by cards. However, most of the people prefer to pay in cash and the transactions through online mode is very limited.

Past learning experience and training support required

Mr. Imaduddin has never attended any training. On the training part he says, **"Training kya chahiye, Kahi jaake len den aur maal laana seekho. Aur business start karo".** As a personal opinion, he thinks that it is good if the training is provided to improve the understanding of the business since many people need it. He believes that small animated videos of 10 minutes will be good in explaining the concepts in an interesting manner.

Willingness to share personal and business data

Mr. Imaduddin denied to share any kind of information- whether personal or business related.

Session 45

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Narsingi, Ranga reddy
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Semi-urban
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Raju
Gender	Male
Age	27
Education	Class 7th
No. of members in the family	3; lives in a joint family
Business is primary income source	Yes; Coconut water seller
Business type	Trading
Bank account ownership	Yes; Savings a/c in SBI, Syndicate Bank
Type of mobile phone	Smartphone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 300,000-450,000
Category of respondent	4

Business establishment

Raju (27) sells coconut water near the main road in Narsingi area of Ranga reddy district which is almost 15-20 Kms from Hyderabad. Raju has been in this business for more than 6 years now. He lives in a joint family with his parents, elder brother, his and elder brother' family. His father and elder brother are also into the same business. They also have similar shop but in different locality. Before venturing into this business, Raju has worked in – transport line, cement shop, mobile repair center, chicken selling shop. He says, the payment or earnings from working as a staff was very less and this only triggered him to start his own business. The initial investment to start this business was INR 10,000, the money was with him in form of savings. He got the idea of selling coconuts from his friends'. The shop is not registered. Raju doesn't have any idea whether his shop needs registration or how to get the shop registered. The only business related expense is INR 3,000 paid as rent. The family also owns a three-wheeler auto which is given on rent and is also used to bring coconuts from market in morning.

Managing business activities

He sells coconut water all-round the year. The sales are highest during the summer time and comparatively lower during early winters (November-December). At peak, he is able to sell 500-600 coconuts per day at INR 30 per piece, while during lean period the sales are 250-300 coconuts at the same rate of INR 30 per piece. The margin per piece of coconut is around INR 6 (20%). This is predominantly a cash intensive business, says Raju. In morning, he goes and buys coconuts and sells them for the whole day. There are two suppliers and he takes coconuts from both of them. He pays them in cash every day. He offers credit to his regular customers only. The number of such customers is also very less and also they make the payment within 2-3 days. He doesn't keep any records rather says that he remembers everything. 'It is easy I know the number of coconuts I have purchased, at the end of the day I count the remaining coconuts. Also, I count the cash and payments received through Paytm and PhonePe'.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

Raju said of not facing any major challenges in conducting his business. 'Simple business hain, coconut lao, becho, khatam'. The only challenge he could think of – availability of coconut. To mitigate this risk, he buys from two different suppliers thus reducing his dependency on just one supplier.

Access and usage levels of banking products

Raju has two savings bank account – one with SBI and other with Syndicate Bank. He saves some money daily and when he is able to accumulate somewhere around INR 10,000-20,000 – he makes deposits in his SBI bank account. He does 'ROSCA/Chitti – informal practice of saving within group' of INR 20,000 per month. The group consists of 20 members. The money obtained during the last cycle of Chitti was used to purchase land. He has two existing loans – two wheeler vehicle loan and a loan taken to purchase an 'expensive smartphone'. He never took a business loan as his business is not capital intensive. The money he earns daily is used to make purchases for the next day, so on and so forth.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

The posters of Paytm, PhonePe accepted here can be seen on his shop. Raju, says almost 1 year back – agents from these companies came and placed those posters and helped him in downloading the app. His is a personal account and not merchant account. The bank account is linked with both these apps and any payment made through the app goes directly into his bank account. Prior to this he had no experience of using these apps, even now he hardly uses these apps for personal or business purposes. On an average, he receives INR 1,000-1,500 as payment from customer through these apps. Other than these he uses Whatsapp, Facebook and YouTube – all these for personal purposes and not for business.

Past learning experience and training support required

Raju said has never attended in any formal training. In past, he worked as apprentice (transport line, cement shop, mobile repair center, and chicken selling shop) and learned the way of doing things by observing others. The coconut selling business doesn't require any special skill. '*The only thing a person needs to know is to identify good quality coconuts and how to cut* those', says Raju. When we discussed the need of trainings, he could not think of anything but when few examples were given – he was interested in the topic 'how can he make his business bigger'. Raju aspires to be a coconut supplier and own a truck.

Given a situation, where he has additional profit of INR 5,000 – he said of depositing it in his bank account rather than investing into his business or doing chitti. 'Can't do a chitti as this is one time income while chitti is a monthly obligation and I will have to plan for it. Don't want to invest into business as I can manage daily purchases from the sales'. Any additional income means savings for Raju.

Since he had two loans, we also asked him – if he knows the consequences of not making EMI paymentS on time. He could only think of penalties and was not aware about credit scores, when explained he said of not knowing about it at all. He has heard of Sukanya Samridhi Yojana but doesn't the exact details of the programme. If such informations are made available it would be helpful for him.

He is more interested in videos than workshop/class room based trainings, as he won't be able to leave his business and travel. 'Video I can see in my free time and learn'. He said of having a network of friends doing other businesses/jobs and they discuss matters ranging from politics, cinema, finance to family, he will definitely discuss and share the learnings within the group. He found videos with real actors more interesting than animated ones. '*Cartoon cartoon hota hain'*. The videos should be short duration– 10 to 15 minutes and can be in any language – Hindi, Telgu.

Willingness to share personal and business data

He is willing to share his phone number, Whatsapp, fb details but not his banking or details such as Aadhaar number or PAN card number. He suspects that these details if shared can lead to fraud.

Session 46

Respondent profile

Particulars	Responses
State	Telangana
District	Narsingi, Ranga reddy
Location type (Rural, Semi-urban, Urban)	Semi-urban
Session Type (Group/Individual)	Individual
Name of respondent	Ketan
Gender	Male
Age	25
Education	Class 8th
No. of members in the family	Unmarried; lives with his parents
Business is primary income source	Yes
Business type	Manufacturing; Car number plates
Bank account ownership	Yes
Type of mobile phone	Smartphone
Monthly revenue from business	INR 50,000-60,000
Category of respondent	2

Business establishment

Ketan (25) has been working in car number plate making shop for 8 years now. He also owns a shop in partnership with his friend. The shop was opened 1 year back. The investment was of INR 400,000 which was contributes by him and his friend equally. He said of having some savings as he has been working for quite some time now, he also borrowed from his relatives. The major investments were made on buying a second hand number plate making machine and computer. The monthly turnover of his business is around INR 50,000-60,000. The margin is of 40-50%.

Managing business activities

Both Ketan and his friend cum partner manage the shop. He has to continue working (other's shop) in order to make additional income so that he can pay-off his borrowings. He earns INR 600 per day while working at the shop. His friend also used to work for the same person on whose shop Ketan is employed. Both of them learned the skill of making number plates, operating machines, designing, etc. by working with others, there was no training as such rather more of an on-the-job learning. While Ketan's friend manages the shop during day time, Ketan manages the shop during evening. The shop is not registered yet and there is no partnership agreement between him and his friend. The daily earnings are distributed equally every day. Both of them contribute to purchase raw materials. The raw materials are purchased in bulk for getting discount and usually such purchases are made once every month or two months depending on the sales. The business related expenses are – rent INR 4,000, electricity INR 1,000.

Risks or challenges faced and perceived in business. Ways to handle them.

'The only risk in this business is of competition from other shops', says Ketan. He could not think of any other business since this is the only skill he has. For past 8 years he has been working in this line. He said of knowing the business quite well. To compete, he offers discounts thus reducing his margin and trying to pursue customers to get the work done at his shop.

Access and usage levels of banking products

Ketan has a savings bank account with SBI. He had no clear purpose of getting the account opened. Also, the saving are not made on regular basis. He has never borrowed from any formal financial institution. In past he

said of borrowing from his relatives when he needed money to venture into number plate making business. He wants to take loan in future to expand his business but is not sure how he will get the loan.

Not doing any ROSCA/Chitti. Hardly has any surplus to do so. However, he knows about such savings, his friends do it.

Access and usage levels of digital infrastructure

He is using a smartphone and uses apps such as Whatsapp, Facebook, YouTube, games. He said of watching number plate making related videos on YouTube to learn the new skills which he doesn't possess. 'These are helpful, people like getting new designs carved on their vehicles'. He sees this as an opportunity to grow his business and stand against his competitors. He also follows the cricket world cup matches on his phone.
His shop accepts payments made through Paytm, PhonePe – 20% of the payments are received through these modes while 80% still remains to be cash. The amount gets deposited in his friend's account.

Past learning experience and training support required

Never gone through any training, rather the skills needed to design the number plates were taught to him by his employer. In terms of skills set on which he could be trained upon are – skills related to his business, accessing loans, schemes from youngsters like him.

Situations – Any additional income will be used to pay-off his debts, firstly. Ketan wants to work till he has paid off all his borrowings. After that he will leave his job and focus full time on his business. He aspires to own a proper shop in 'Gachibowli' area in coming years. On marketing - He will place a big board outside his shop that will give him visibility.

'It will be very difficult for me to attend workshop/class room based trainings', says Ketan. He preferred short videos on business skill building, financial management. He is fine with both Hindi, Telgu as language. Preferred real actors in the video over animated videos.

Willingness to share personal and business data

He can share his details;, he says he cannot think of any risk or harm in sharing it.